

used tools like Rotate and Crop. As already mentioned, being coded in HTML each menu selection is accompanied by a page refresh. In turn, you have to be patient enough as the refreshing can take time depending on the size of the image being modified.

The Edit menu offers the options to Crop and Resize the image. The Draw menu has options to insert Text into the image. The position of the text can be altered by dragging it. Other tools grouped in this menu are the Border tool, Fill/Paint bucket tool, Freehand drawing tool and the Speech Bubble tool. The Zit and Blemish remover is a smoothening tool in disguise. The Cosmetic Surgery tool allows selected areas in the image to be squeezed or expanded.

The Adjust menu groups some of the other familiar tools—Flip, Blur, Motion Blur, Contrast/Saturation control, Greyscale conversion, Sepia tone addition, and Red Eye Reduction. The need to continuously reload the image takes away from the fun of watching the results of these tools, but nonetheless they are still useful.

The Effects menu is what makes Lunapic worthy of mention. The long list of effects contains esoteric names like Andy Warhol Effect, Thermal Effect, Lightning effect, and Fire Effect. Some of the effects that have been previously experienced are Charcoal, Pencil Sketch and Emboss. Using most of these effects is a single click affair, with no user configurable options.

Lunapic also supports several animation effects. The old Java applet based Reflecting water effect still makes its presence felt in the list (though in this case it is a .gif file). To view sample animations, click on the More animations link.

Completed files can be saved in a variety of formats such as .jpg and .png (without animation), and .gif and .swf (animation).

Lunapic is a very strange site to say the least. In spite of all the goodies, the site seems stuck in a time warp, as advances in Web site scripting apparently have given this site the slip. The use of antiquated HTML to power a site



Lunapic's toolbox and menu